

solutions. Personal experience further strengthened Shenoy's belief in the need for such a solution. Shenoy recalls: "When I started working on Linux six to seven years back, I had a tough time as I learnt everything myself and then used Linux to build embedded devices. The process was time consuming; it took double time to build the embedded Linux product. Considering time is money in our business, it was a loss for the company," says Shenoy. He adds: "If I had adequate training I would have been able to ensure timely delivery of products employing Linux."

The lucrative business model around training solutions was an added attraction for Shenoy. "We decided to take the plunge in training solutions as initial costs were low, plus the business looked promising. We have no regrets as not only have we broken even but also earned profits in a short span," says Shenoy.

A one-stop-shop for embedded Linux training

In April 2009, Shenoy Systems began offering training solutions in generic Linux, OS internals, BSP (Board Support Package), RTOS and device drivers for individuals, corporates and educational institutions. However, bagging the first orders for training solutions didn't come easy for Shenoy. They had to prove their worth when compared to academicians and well-established Linux solution providers.

The company promoted the practical experience of its team as its USP to sell training solutions. "We at Shenoy weren't academicians with only theoretical knowledge. We had the industry experience by which we could enable professionals to use Linux for building products. We could even provide hands-on experience. This became our USP and helped us crack our first deals," says Shenoy.

Further, the price competency of the training solutions attracted corporates and developers. "While the cost of Linux training courses for companies was over Rs 60,000, we charged one-third of it. Similarly, for individuals or fresh engineers/students we offered training at a lower price," says Shenoy. Finally, after a month-long struggle, Shenoy Systems got its first clients for training solutions. "Our first clients were L&T, EmSys and Tata Elxsi where we held training in embedded systems, RTOS, embedded C, embedded Linux and generic open source courses," says Shenoy.



"With an improvement in support, services and training around Linux, we predict exponential growth for Linux-based devices."

—Naveen Shenoy, MD and founder of Shenoy Systems

Shenoy today: always innovating

Today, Shenoy Systems has an impressive list of corporate clients that include Arrow, HCL, D-Link, HP, Aspect, Samsung, Tata Elxsi, and L&T Infotech. Further, they have two partners—AayuSmart and Oasis Technology. Currently, the company is involved in a medical device project. "We are working with AayuSmart, our partner, on building medical devices like glucose devices, BP apparatus, ECG machines, etc. These devices will make patient reports accessible to a doctor at anytime, from anywhere. The small 4x6 inch (10.2x15.2 cm) ECG machine can be connected to a cell phone and data can be uploaded on the Internet through GPRS, SMS or Bluetooth. This will be a step ahead from the telemedicine that makes data on the patient available within the hospital premises," says Shenoy.

The company is constantly working on improving the delivery of existing solutions. "Apart from classroom-based training, we impart audio-ware training that provides a student flexibility to come and learn as per his convenience. Every candidate gets a DVD player and notes. The audio tracks have detailed explanations on the topic, while the notes carry the diagrams and theory aspects. In case of doubts, the on-premise trainer clarifies them instantly," says Shenoy. Such innovations ensure quality learning, and break time barriers. They are extremely beneficial for working professionals looking for a career shift to embedded systems, embedded professionals trying to gain expertise in the domain, and fresh engineering graduates or diploma holders.

Elaborating on the merits of the audio-ware programme, Shenoy says: "We also provide hands-on experience that enables candidates to walk the talk with concepts they learn from audio. The audio courses are currently available for embedded systems, RTOS and soon shall be started for Linux," says Shenoy.

However, maintaining quality doesn't come easy for Shenoy. Security of information/ training material is crucial. "There is no scope for tampering with the training recordings. The DVD player is sealed with a sticker and our staff ensures everything runs smoothly. We are also working on disabling USB ports so that the student concentrates only on the lessons," says Shenoy.